VIT BHOPAL

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION:

This project involves educating others about digital literacy and how to utilize technology in a responsible and professional manner. As the world is becoming increasingly reliable on technology for communication and work purposes, students must learn how to effectively use digital tools, communicate professionally, and protect themselves against cybercrime. As a student digital ambassador, I've worked to create useful examples and resources so that other students can develop their own digital literacy skills and improve their digital habits.

There are five tasks that make up this project, with each task focusing on one area of digital literacy. The tasks include designing a digital literacy infographic, creating a professional student digital portfolio, researching coding and collaboration platforms, preparing for professional email communication, and investigating ways to prevent and respond to cybercrime. Both practical activities and written reflections are included in these tasks.

In the remaining sections of this report, I will provide detailed descriptions of each of the five tasks, including the tools I used in completing each task, as well as the reflections made after completing the task.

Task1: Create A Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Write-up :

I used Canva to make a one-page infographic on digital literacy. I chose Canva because it has many templates, icons and design tools that make creating visually appealing educational content easy to do, even for someone who has never done it before . Using this platform, I created a simple and informative visual slide that describes why digital literacy is important to students.

The infographic illustrates 6 points:

1. What is Digital Literacy
2. Why it matters
3. Stay safe online
4. Challenges in the Digital world
5. Be a smart user
6. Helpful Digital tools

In the first section of the infographic, I briefly describe what digital literacy means (the ability to use technology in a responsible and effective manner). In The second section of the infographic I have emphasized that digital literacy is not just about using technology but using it wisely and responsibly. In the third section of the infographic, I have included ways of safe internet practices, including using strong password, avoiding suspicious links, and protecting personal online information). In the fourth section, I have briefed about the risks and problems associated with the internet.

The fifth section of the infographic has encouraged users to practice responsible and ethical digital behaviour. The final section of the infographic introduces some useful digital tools that supports learning and collaboration.

The most interesting aspect of creating this infographic has been finding the appropriate icons and layouts that clearly represent the information and are visually appealing. The hardest aspect of this assignment has been placing the content on the page so that all of the information can be included on one page without the design looking cluttered. By completing this assignment, I have learned the role of visual communication in presenting complex information in a way that makes sense.

Task 2 : Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Write-up :

I established a GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle account for the purposes of creating a professional digital portfolio to display to others my accomplishments in these areas and where I want to expand my knowledge for the future.

- GitHub is a space for developers to store and manage their coding projects as well as for them to collaborate through using repositories. In creating my GitHub account, I made a README file that provided my name, branch, educational level, and brief description about my educational goals. I intend to upload my coding assignments as well as my personal projects and/or any other technical work to my GitHub in order to track my current level of knowledge over the next four years.

- LinkedIn is a social media platform designed for professionals to connect with others in the same profession or industry and find job opportunities. I enhanced my LinkedIn profile by adding educational information and adding my personal achievements including my certifications in various programs . I also plan to use LinkedIn to learn more about industries and companies by following them, so that I will understand what is happening in my industry, and to find potential internships.

- Kaggle provides datasets and coding competitions for individuals to use to practice their data science as well as machine learning skills. I plan to use Kaggle to help develop my analytical and problem-solving skills. All of these profiles will help create a solid foundation for my professional digital presence as I build my career as a data scientist.

Task 3 : Explore Coding & Collaboration Platform

Write-up :

To complete the project for coding practice, I have solved the coding challenge on the platform HackerRank by creating an account and completing the beginner-level challenge ‘Solve Me First.’ This coding challenge involved writing a simple code to calculate the sum of two integers. Even though this is a simple coding problem, it gave me an idea of how coding platforms function and how the coding challenges are presented. Completing this coding challenge has boosted my confidence and motivated me to practice more coding problems.

I created a Google Form called Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. The quiz consists of five questions designed to test students' basic understanding of digital literacy concepts. Additionally, the questions include both multiple choice and short answer formats, and the answers to the questions will automatically be collected in a linked Google Sheet, making it easy to view and sort through the data.

By using Google Forms and Google Sheets, I can collect information, conduct surveys, and manage data. Therefore, these tools will help me with my studies because they will make it easier for me to collaborate with other people, share information, and organize projects.

Task 4 : Draft A Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Write-up :

Poor digital communication in academics manifests as misinterpretation due to lack of nonverbal cues, information overload, and technical barriers, often resulting in lower engagement, increased anxiety, and missed deadlines. Poor digital communication can lead to issues when communicating with professors about important academic issues.

For instance, The students were working on a project and communicating through the WhatsApp group. One of the students had the task of submitting the final report before the deadline. One of the students in the group had sent the file to the group and written, “Here is the final file, please check.” However, the student in charge of submitting the file did not understand this and thought the file had to undergo further corrections.
The problem occurred because the message sent did not make sense.

The problem could have been solved if the student had sent the message with the following text: “This is the final report, please submit it before the deadline.”
The problem occurred due to the failure of the students to send the correct message. This problem could have been solved if the students had sent the correct message.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Write-up :

During the course of the research on online safety and cybercrimes, I found the most surprising thing to be the prevalence of digital fraud in the form of phishing messages, links, and UPI scams. People lose money just by clicking on unknown links and divulging confidential information such as OTP and UPI PIN without being aware of the consequences. What also surprised me is the fact that most cybercriminals target young and naive internet users such as students who regularly use digital payment apps and social media.

This research has also increased my awareness about the need to adopt safe online practices. I have realized the need to be more careful before clicking on unknown links or sending messages pertaining to digital payments and account verification. I also need to ensure the strength of the password and not divulge confidential information such as OTP and UPI PIN. This would help in preventing most online crimes.

CONCLUSION

The overall takeaway from the project was the realization that digital literacy essentially comprises technical skills, responsible behavior, and professional awareness in the virtual environment. Through the completion of all the different tasks, I was able to gain first-hand experience in the use of digital media not only for learning but also for establishing my professional self.

The creation of my digital portfolio through sites like GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle also allowed me to understand the ways in which students can begin to develop their professional self at an early stage in their academic life. On the other hand, the exploration of different sites for coding practice also allowed me to understand the ways in which technology can be utilized for learning and developing skills.

The other important takeaway from the project was the realization of the importance of effective digital communication and responsible behavior in the virtual environment. Through the learning about cybercrime, I was able to understand the importance of being responsible in the virtual environment.

The overall takeaway from the project was the realization that digital literacy essentially comprises communicating professionally, being responsible in the virtual environment, and utilizing technology to develop academic opportunities.

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